Information Technology Disaster Recovery Planning Policy

From the Office of the Chief Information Officer, State of Minnesota

Version: 1.7
Effective Date: 01/01/2016
Revised: 12/31/2024
Approved: John Israel, State Chief Information Security Officer **Date:** 3/20/2025

Policy Statement

Information technology disaster recovery (IT DR) plans must be in place that align with the priorities and recovery timelines of state agency critical priority services to ensure the State of Minnesota is adequately managing the risk of system and service interruptions.

Employees must abide by the terms of this policy. Employees who violate this policy may be subject to discipline, up to and including discharge.

Reason for the Policy

Interruptions to information technology systems can have a severe impact on the State of Minnesota's ability to provide critical priority services. IT DR plans provide a roadmap to recover systems so they are available to support the continuation of State critical priority services in the event of an emergency or system disruption with minimal downtime, data loss and impact to State operations.

Roles & Responsibilities

- Employees, Vendors, and Contractors
    - Be aware of and follow relevant information security, continuity of operations, and IT DR policies, standards, and procedures.
    - Ensure information security, continuity of operations, and IT DR is incorporated into processes and procedures.
    - Ensure contractors and vendors are following required information security controls and have the required continuity of operations and IT DR plans and capabilities.
    - Contact the MNIT continuity of operations coordinator, information security staff or email GRC@state.mn.us with questions about the information security, continuity of operations, and IT DR policies, standards, or procedures.

- Supervisors and Managers
    - Ensure employees and contractors are proficient in the information security, continuity of operations, and IT DR policies, standards and procedures that are relevant to their role in system recovery.
    - Hold employees accountable for following the information security, continuity of operations, and IT DR policies, standards, and procedures.
- Information Technology Personnel
    - Apply appropriate controls to the design, operation, and maintenance of systems, processes, and procedures in conformance with the information security, continuity of operations, and IT DR policies, standards, and procedures.
- Information Security Personnel
    - Develop, maintain, and assess compliance with the information security policies, standards, and procedures.
    - Develop, maintain, and implement a comprehensive information security program.
    - Provide training on information security policies, standards, and procedures.
    - Assist agencies and personnel with understanding and implementing information security policies, standards, and procedures.
- Agency Data Practices Personnel
    - Assist agencies and personnel with questions on proper data use, collection, storage, destruction, and disclosure.
- MNIT Continuity of Operations Coordinator
    - Develop, maintain, and assess MNIT compliance with the continuity of operations and IT DR policies, standards, and procedures.
    - Develop, maintain, and implement a comprehensive MNIT continuity of operations program.
    - Provide training on continuity of operations and IT DR policies, standards, and procedures to MNIT employees.
    - Assist agencies and personnel with understanding and implementing continuity of operations and IT DR policies, standards, and procedures.

Applicability

This policy applies to all departments, agencies, offices, councils, boards, commissions, and other entities in the executive branch of Minnesota State Government.

Related Information

IT Disaster Recovery Planning Standard

State Standards and Authoritative Source Cross Mapping

Governor’s Executive Order 15-13

Governor’s Executive Order 15-14

History

Table 1. Version History

Version	Description	Date
1.0	Initial Release	7/8/2015
1.1	Added Compliance Enforcement Date	12/29/2015
1.2	Updated Compliance Enforcement Date	12/20/2016
1.3	Updated Compliance Enforcement Date	10/17/2017
1.4	Retitled and updated to reflect IT focus	3/10/2020
1.5	Removed Compliance Enforcement Date and grammar corrections	10/2/2022
1.6	Updated version number and revision dates	10/1/2023
1.7	Added enforcement language; updated version and revision date	12/2/2024

Contact

GRC@state.mn.us